rhetoric—can be viewed here as mode of political maneuvering confused with memorial recognition.

In addition to Wiesel, American cultural figures responded loudly to Reagan's visit to Bitburg. The trip inspired at least two musical rebuttals: the Ramones' "Bonzo Goes to Bitburg" and Frank Zappa's "Reagan at Bitburg." In an interview with *Spin*, Joey Ramone (otherwise generally a supporter of Reagan) said, "We had watched Reagan going to visit the SS cemetery on TV and were disgusted. … We're all good Americans, but Reagan's thing was like forgive and forget. How can you forget six million people being gassed and roasted."[20] In another visual cultural response, African American expatriate cartoonist Oliver "Ollie" Harrington, who had lived in East Berlin since 1961, drew two editorial cartoons on the subject for the Communist newspaper *Daily World*. In the first, a grinning Reagan walks toward a gravestone with a wreath labeled "from Ron." Under the ground, one uniformed skeleton with SS paraphernalia rises to attention. In the second, another skeleton, again in combat gear, stands up from his grave and reads an official-looking decree titled "Full Pardon" and signed by Ronald Reagan and Helmut Kohl.[21] The cultural reverberations across the Atlantic revealed the problematic nature of historical memory and prevailing fears of ethnic violence in Germany underlying the intended act of commemoration.

If the president's stated goal was commemoration and furthering reconciliation in West Germany, such an action occurred in the wake of two currents in the United States. The first was a reacceleration of the Cold War through U.S. foreign policy actions. This resulted in a segue from Cold War détente following the end of the Vietnam War to the policy of "rollback" of direct military intervention or covert operations in nonaligned or socialist-led countries. This was propelled, in part, by President Reagan's concept of the Soviet Union as an "evil empire," even as possibilities for peace talks emerged. In 1983, Reagan announced the speculative "Star Wars" missile defense system and partnered with NATO to station 572 Cruise and Pershing II missiles across Europe, including 108 in West Germany. During this period, the United States also carried out military aggression or intervention through the support of counterrevolutionary forces in the Caribbean, Latin America, Africa, and the Middle East, due to fear of containment and to secure valuable commodities. This diverse and far-reaching group of foreign interventions points to the ways the view of a reexacerbated bipolar Cold War with the Soviet Union during the Reagan years underwrote a large